Haiven 2025-26 Employee Handbook

Table of Contents

- Welcome to the Team
- Legal Notice
- Our Philosophy and Values
- Leadership and Management Team
- Company History and Background
- Company Standards
    - Confidentiality
    - Attire and Dress Code
    - Business Hours, General Availability, and Daily Planning
    - Our HR System
    - Working Remotely
    - Sick Days
    - Reporting Absences
    - Equal Opportunity Employment, Non-Discrimination, and Anti-Harassment
    - Computer, Software, Email, and Internet Use
    - Communication
    - Time Tracking
    - Pay Period and Direct Deposit
    - Overtime
    - Travel
- Employee Benefits
    - Healthcare
    - Vision Insurance
    - Dental Insurance
    - Retirement Plan
    - Holidays
- Paid Time Off (PTO) Policy
- Additional Policies
    - Code of Conduct
    - Performance Reviews
    - Training and Development
    - Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion
- Jury Duty and Military Leave
- Employee Acknowledgment

Welcome to Haiven! This handbook outlines the conduct we expect from all employees; in return, it details the benefits we provide to you as a highly valued member of our team. At Haiven, we take great pride in our team. The fact that you've been hired means we see you as a top performer, a talented resource, and someone key to reaching our ambitious goals. We're truly excited to have you here!

We wholeheartedly believe that if we treat our partners, customers, vendors, and fellow team members with the same respect, courtesy, and friendliness that we seek from others, together we'll build a successful company that's both personally and financially rewarding for everyone. This means you have a real stake in Haiven's growth. Only by working together as a team to build a profitable and successful company can we gain the greatest reward: continual improvement of our team's success and our livelihood!

Unless otherwise noted, the contents of this handbook apply to all employees (and contractors where applicable) at Haiven. Sometimes, the contents or expectations here might conflict with the terms of any written employment or independent contractor agreement between Haiven and an employee. If that's the case, the employment or independent contractor agreement will govern. All employment at Haiven is completely "at will."

Haiven was founded on Christian values and believes in using our God-given gifts and talents to serve others with excellence. While our roots are faith-inspired, we welcome employees of all backgrounds who align with our mission and values. No one is to be denied any opportunity or benefit based on age, sex, color, race, creed, national origin, religious affiliation, marital status, vaccination status, political belief, sexual orientation, or disability that does not prohibit performance of essential job functions. In fact, we encourage diversity and actively seek to diversify our team and corporate culture. We're a family! We celebrate the differences between us and the opportunities it provides for a well-rounded team.

Legal Notice

Haiven reserves the right as a business, within the constraints of what employment laws and economic conditions dictate, to modify, rescind, delete, or add to any part or parts of this handbook without prior notice, at any time it deems appropriate and necessary, in its sole and absolute discretion. No statement or promise made by a supervisor, manager, or other employee of Haiven is to be interpreted as a change in policy; nor will it otherwise constitute an agreement with an employee or individual. Should any provision in this handbook be found to be unenforceable and invalid, such finding does not invalidate the entire handbook, but only the subject provision.

Questions? Ask away at hr@haiven.gg

Our Philosophy and Values

Communication

- First and foremost, we are a communication company: over-communication creates excellent work.
- We are efficient, particularly in electronic communication.
- There is a time and place to be detailed and thorough.
- We maintain strong voices and respect the voices of others.
- Great communication creates great relationships.

Passion

- We are inventors and love innovation.
- We have a love of science, technology, and the beauty of mathematics.
- Work hard. Play hard. We believe in the healthy balance of both.

Team

- Each member on our team and the expertise they bring is critical to our success.
- Lead by example, regardless of job title or expectations; or put differently: Lead from where you are!
- Be proactive and self-starting. We know you're talented and trust your decisions.
- Be a lifelong learner, and take risks. Learn from mistakes so they don't need to be repeated.
- Be self-aware and take ownership of your expertise, successes, and mishaps.
- Be willing to "go the extra mile" for the benefit and growth of the team when required.
- Genuinely and authentically respect every peer. Culture precedes cash.
- Give every member on our team a voice to brainstorm, think openly, and collaborate.
- Operate within a culture of success, growth, and celebration of learning from mistakes, rather than fear of being disposable.
- Periodically "reset" as leadership and as an entire team. Regularly evaluate processes, efficiencies, profitability, and growth to make necessary adjustments, additions, and eliminations; and thus adhere to our belief in continual improvement.
- Be a part of the team: physically and mentally ready, virtually present, engaged, and active.
- Value a fit mind and body. Support all team members in pursuing both, actively.
- Always be conscious about spending. Every penny we spend is a penny that is not reinvested or distributed to the team (including the company's shareholders).

Integrity

- Honesty and integrity are vital in our roles as team members, both in our products and in our relationships with clients: We do what we say and say only what we are able to do.
- Honor deadlines and the responsibility of being reliable.

- Be upfront and forthright in all that we say and do.
- Be 100% available as required by our team, customers, partners, and vendors.

Quality Through Efficiency

- Be proactive, not reactive.
- Strive for efficient, succinct communication through email and attentive listening.
- Believe in a defined process and the importance of note-taking, task organization, and reliability.
- Value agility and "the pivot."
- Respect the value of execution, not simply talk.
- Be calculated, accurate, and clean; whether code or your workspace, cleanliness rules.
- Buy quality, buy smart.

Customers/Partners

- Reach consumers in innovative ways in an increasingly saturated market.
- Every customer and client is a chance for us to create an evangelist. Serve them.
- Use information to improve ourselves and our products. Discuss, measure, and optimize.
- Appreciate the art of communication. Be aware of both the need to talk and listen.

Leadership and Management Team

At the present, Haiven is a small business governed by a board of directors, which includes our founders.

The corporate management team consists of key roles focused on strategy, vision, operations, finance, marketing, development, production, and creative leadership. Your direct supervisor will introduce you to the team during onboarding. We're here to support your success and growth.

Company History and Background

Haiven was founded in 2025, by Luke and Jen Richey and Chantelle Price, with a small group of experienced professionals.

Driven by a passion for innovation and bringing cutting-edge solutions to the mainstream, we opened our doors and have evolved into the dynamic team you see today.

Company Standards

At Haiven, it's our intention to provide the highest possible standard in our work. Each individual associated with the company must recognize that he or she has a personal responsibility to maintain this standard and the company's reputation for expertise, efficiency, and integrity. This responsibility applies to each member in every department.

The relationship between Haiven and our clients is unique and must be founded upon trust and confidence. Our game developers and their players are the most important people we come into contact with. Without them, Haiven cannot survive. Accordingly, it's critical that they are treated with the greatest respect and with true appreciation of their importance to us.

Confidentiality

One of the cornerstones of the trust and confidence we build is confidentiality. You will (or have already) signed a non-disclosure agreement (NDA). In addition, when we work with customers, contractors, and some vendors, we require NDAs before sharing any sensitive data about the client name or project. Many times, the project and/or client information is protected by a signed services agreement, meaning we are contractually bound to keep aspects in confidence.

This philosophy should always be top of mind as we collaborate and delegate. When in doubt, verify the security level of the information. If verification is not possible, err on the side of asking for an NDA.

Attire and Dress Code

At Haiven, we believe that comfortable employees are productive employees. For this reason, the company does not officially restrict the attire you can wear to work. Please feel free, within reason and respect to others, to dress in comfortable, casual attire. From time to time, the company may ask staff to step up their attire if we entertain prospective customers or conduct other business with guests.

For positions or responsibilities that require direct engagement with customers, clients, and other external parties, it's expected that all staff dress in a professional manner suitable for the meeting and have their computer cameras on for virtual meetings. If you have questions about acceptable attire for a specific situation, contact hr@haiven.gg.

Business Hours, General Availability, and Daily Planning

Haiven's official hours are Monday-Friday, 8:00 AM to 5:00 PM Pacific Time, although we're flexible in setting schedules that work for individuals rather than the whole. You'll be asked to select your regular work schedule and share it with your supervisor so the team knows when you'll be available. It's expected that during business hours, all employees are present or generally available unless prior approval has been communicated and documented on the calendar.

Our HR System

Haiven uses a PEO G&A Partners and their platform and system to manage human resources and payroll, including but not limited to:

- Hiring
- Onboarding

- Training
- Offboarding
- Personnel information
- Paid Time Off (PTO) including holiday, sick, vacation
- Time Off Requests*
- Birthdays
- Calendar Syncing for vacation, sick, and other out-of-office events
- Salary Adjustments
- Documentation

*All formal time off requests must be submitted to your immediate supervisor through a G&A webform.

Working Remotely

Haiven's search for talented team members has gone national. With remote work as the norm, Haiven operates fully remote for all employees. When working from home, we ask that all employees continue their roles and follow company guidelines (schedule time off, communicate with supervisors, etc.) as if in an office. Working from home every day isn't required (but a reliable internet connection is), and we understand a change of scenery like a coffee shop is sometimes needed. That said, we ask that you are online and present for the team during 9 AM to 3 PM PST. Beyond that, feel free to fill your 8-hour workday as you wish.

We realize life happens. Sometimes, you or your family will get sick. You may have events that can only be scheduled during the day, Monday through Friday. Please remember, this is a privilege and not an entitlement. Each team member is still expected to perform as though in the office. Most importantly, be available for your teammates. Communicate any scheduling conflicts to your supervisor as far in advance as possible and ensure your event is on the calendar.

Sick Days

If you are feeling sick, we proactively encourage all team members to rest up! If you are able to work, please be sure to do so (we all count on each other!).

We understand that there are instances where rest is the only remedy to getting better. In these instances, please email all sick announcements to your immediate supervisor and if you are out a full day let HR know too. The goal is clear communication about the status and whereabouts of all teammates, documented on the calendar so everyone can check the Out of Office (OOO) calendar when looking for colleagues.

Reporting Absences

Anticipated absences from work should be scheduled as soon as practical so the team knows about out-of-office or vacation plans. Any and all absences must be requested through the HR

system as soon as possible. For non-exempt employees, prior approval by your direct supervisor(s) is required for any makeup hours.

Non-exempt employees (still in the waiting period for benefits) who miss work due to illness, inclement weather, or other situations must discuss this with the HR manager and/or their supervisor. Upon approval, all employees are expected to add their anticipated absence(s) to the shared OOO calendar.

Equal Opportunity Employment, Non-Discrimination, Anti-Harassment

Haiven is an equal opportunity employer and service provider. The company will not engage in or tolerate any discrimination on the basis of race, creed, color, religion, ancestry, national origin, age, sex, marital status, vaccination status, gender, or the presence of any mental or physical disability, sensory handicap, or other distinguishing characteristics in hiring, training, promotion, benefits, or any terms and conditions of employment.

Further, it's a violation of Haiven's policy for any employee to discriminate on any of the above bases against any client, project, member of the public, or internal team members including employees, board members, contractors, interns (paid or unpaid), volunteers, families, patrons, and all other visitors. This includes harassment, intimidation, or bullying while at work, at any Haiven-sponsored event, or when such actions create a substantial disruption to Haiven's business. Any discriminatory action or harassment will not be tolerated and should be reported immediately in writing to the offending employee's supervisor, HR Manager, or, in appropriate cases, the CEO. Violations will result in corrective action, up to and including termination.

Haiven strives to provide all employees with optimal conditions for learning and growing as valued individuals and team members. This means each of us takes responsibility to ensure all team members are treated with respect.

Any team member who observes, overhears, or witnesses harassment, intimidation, or bullying, or to whom such actions have been reported, must take prompt and appropriate action to stop it and prevent recurrence.

Haiven will ensure compliance with all state laws regarding harassment, intimidation, or bullying.

Any Haiven team member may confidentially report an incident violating the anti-harassment and non-discrimination policy by speaking privately with the HR manager or via email at hr@haiven.gg .

Computer, Software, Email, and Internet Use

Employees using Haiven accounts are acting as company representatives. As such, act responsibly and appropriately. Haiven may inspect, monitor, and disclose contents on any company-owned or leased machine, device, phone, or online account when:

1. Required by and consistent with law;
2. There is substantial reason to believe violations of law or Haiven policy have occurred;
3. In some cases, to meet time-dependent, critical operations needs.

We encourage employees to keep all accounts and shared drive folders minimal, clean, organized, and complete. All work should be stored in the appropriate shared drive folder, which backs up automatically. For developers, commit code to the repository as frequently as possible.

Due to the nature of electronic communications, email should not be considered private. Once sent, neither you nor the company can prevent a message from being distributed beyond the intended recipient. Email may be monitored and backed up. Deleted messages may exist on backups and are subject to disclosure. Using a company account or server to send duplicative, unsolicited email (commercial or otherwise), or to collect responses from unsolicited email, is prohibited. This includes publishing a private email to third parties without the author's consent.

If you need to borrow equipment for home use, let your manager know so it can be logged.

Communication

At Haiven, employees communicate primarily through email and our chat tool. Time-sensitive information goes through Slack. Email is for client/customer/partner-facing communication, information best documented, or non-urgent after-hours messages. Slack is organized by channels and private direct or group messages. During onboarding, you'll get a Haiven email and Slack account. Your manager will arrange for you to be added to relevant channels.

We use Jira, a project management platform to coordinate software projects. Product Managers create boards with tasks, files, links, notes, and related info. This tracks processes through discovery, design, and development. Best practices include:

1. Log time to specific tasks (if possible) and add descriptions.
2. Complete assigned tasks by due dates.
3. Document findings in the notes section.
4. Add links and files to the board.
5. Use comments for technical and project items; tag those who need notification.

With remote work and clients across locations, meetings are via video conferencing (unless specified otherwise). All employees must update their Google calendar to show availability (time off, appointments, etc.). Calendar upkeep is vital as leads check for scheduling meetings.

Pay Period and Direct Deposit

Haiven's pay period is semi-monthly, based on 24 pay dates, equating to 86.67 hours per period. Pay dates are the 1st and 16th of each month. If on a weekend or holiday when banks are closed, payroll is on the next business day.

Payroll is via our HR system, all by direct deposit. If unable to use direct deposit, discuss alternatives with HR.

Payday advances are not considered except in extraordinary circumstances.

Accounts in direct deposit are submitted as detailed. Processing time varies by institution; contact your bank for details.

Questions on payroll? Direct to HR manager or hr@haiven.gg.

Overtime

Business volume may require overtime. Professional and exempt employees work hours needed to complete tasks and are exempt from this section.

Non-exempt employees are scheduled no more than 8 hours per day or 40 per week. The work week for accounting starts 12:01 AM Monday and ends midnight Sunday.

Overtime for non-exempt is per state guidelines: hours over 40 in a week. Pay is straight hourly up to 40, time-and-a-half over. Paid leave and holidays don't count as worked time for overtime. Non-exempt must get written supervisor approval before working over 40 hours. No exceptions.

Travel

When traveling for Haiven, you represent the team; decisions affect how we're viewed. Consuming alcohol is not against policy, but do so professionally and responsibly.

Many travel costs are reimbursable if no company card. Sometimes a per diem check is issued; otherwise, reimbursed on next pay date after submission. Keep receipts (photos ok). Submit a simple expense report for accounting.

Alcohol is not covered; separate and pay personally.

Employee Benefits

Haiven is committed to the health and wellness of employees and families. We provide these benefits (eligible after waiting period; enroll when first eligible or at annual open enrollment, typically January 1).

Healthcare

Our medical plan is administered by G&A Partners and provides comprehensive coverage for you and/or family. Haiven pays about 50% of employee premium for full-time; dependent premiums are paid 100% by employee. You must work >32 hours/week to qualify for benefits. See plan booklet for details. Questions? hr@haiven.gg.

Vision Insurance

Vision services are under the medical plan. See booklet for details. Questions? hr@haiven.gg.

Dental Insurance

Dental coverage available. See booklet for details. Questions? hr@haiven.gg.

Holidays

Haiven observes about 10 holidays yearly, depending on dates. If on the weekend, we may observe an adjacent day, decided 15 days prior.

For 2025, observed paid holidays (office closed):

- New Year's Day
- Good Friday/Passover
- Memorial Day
- Independence Day
- Labor Day
- Thanksgiving & Day After
- Christmas Eve & Christmas Day

Paid Time Off (PTO) Policy

PTO for non-sick days should be submitted 14 days in advance.

Haiven offers PTO after 90 days employment, increasing with service:

- Hire through 4 years: 80 hours/year. Accrue at 3.33 hours/pay period; eligible after 90 days.
- Start of 5th through 9th year: 120 hours/year. Accrue at 5 hours/pay period.

PTO subject to supervisor approval. Document in shared OOO calendar and HR system. Approved first-come, first-served for coverage. No carryover or cash-out.

Accrual example: Hire 3/1/25 accrues 3.33/pay until 3/1/29, then 5/pay; 3/1/34 to 6.67/pay.

Additional Policies

Code of Conduct

We expect all employees to act with integrity, professionalism, and respect. This includes following all policies, laws, and ethical standards in your work and interactions. Violations may lead to disciplinary action.

Performance Reviews

Reviews occur annually, with informal check-ins quarterly. We discuss goals, achievements, and growth opportunities to support your development.

Training and Development

Haiven invests in your growth through training programs, workshops, and resources. Discuss needs with your supervisor to align with company goals.

Jury Duty and Military Leave

Haiven does not compensate for jury duty but may request a court stay if timing impacts projects (court's discretion).

Employees get unpaid time off for military leave. Regular employees maintain status through duties. Submit via HR system.

Employee Acknowledgment

Please read and return a signed copy to your manager by the end of your first week. I have read this handbook and its core values in full. By accepting my position at Haiven, I agree to abide by all policies. I will act professionally and with integrity in all interactions and representation of Haiven. If I have questions, I'll bring them to my supervisor(s) ASAP.

Employee Name (Printed): _____

Employee Signature: _____

Date: _____